Rate Limits

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DhanHQ enforces rate limits to ensure fair usage and platform stability.

API CATEGORY	RATE	PER-REQUEST CAP	DAILY LIMIT
Order APIs	10 req/sec	—	7,000
Data APIs	5 req/sec	—	100,000
Market Quote	1 req/sec	1,000 instruments	—
Option Chain	1 req / 3 sec 10 unique scrips / 8 sec	1 scrip	—

Market Quote Limits

- Maximum **1,000 instruments** per request for LTP/OHLC/Quote endpoints
- **1 request per second** across all market quote endpoints

Option Chain Limits

Two limits apply to Option Chain, and both are enforced together. A request is rejected if either the per-request rate OR the unique-scrip cap is exceeded.

- **1 request per 3 seconds** per underlying/expiry combination
- **10 unique scrips per 8 seconds** — at most 10 distinct underlyings may be queried in any 8 seconds

Handling Rate Limits

When you exceed the rate limit, the API returns:

```
{
  "status": "failure",
  "errorType": "RATE_LIMIT_ERROR",
  "errorCode": "RL001",
  "errorMessage": "Too many requests. Please retry after 1 second."
}
```

Best Practices

1. **Batch requests** — Use multi-instrument endpoints (e.g., LTP for multiple instruments in one call)
2. **Cache data** — Cache market data locally and refresh at appropriate intervals
3. **Exponential backoff** — When rate limited, wait and retry with increasing delays

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4. **Queue orders** — Don't fire all orders simultaneously; space them out

Python Example with Rate Limiting

```python
import time
from dhanhq import DhanContext, dhanhq

context = DhanContext("client_id", "access_token")
dhan = dhanhq(context)

# Get LTP for multiple instruments in a single call
instruments = [
    ("NSE_EQ", "1333"),
    ("NSE_EQ", "11536"),
    ("NSE_EQ", "2885"),
]
ltp = dhan.get_ltp(instruments)

# Space out order placements
orders = [...]  # your order list
for order in orders:
    response = dhan.place_order(**order)
    print(response)
    time.sleep(0.1)  # 100ms delay between orders
```

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About DhanHQ

We're trying to shape the future of trading with technology.

DhanHQ is our commitment to empowering India's trading ecosystem with advanced, low-latency infrastructure. Built on the same robust technology that powers Dhan, DhanHQ offers free trading APIs, real-time market data, and a comprehensive suite of tools tailored for traders, developers, and fintech platforms. Whether you're building custom trading systems or embedding wealth products into your product, DhanHQ provides the flexibility and speed you need. With state-of-the-art infrastructure and a developer-friendly approach, we're enabling a new era of trading innovation in India.

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